

There are 93,578 rural job holders in Latehar. It has a NREGS fund of Rs. 67.30 crore. About 20,000 applications were received from the aggrieved rural workers out of NREGS at the Lok Adalat. The Hon'ble Executive Chairman, JHALSA, constituted 20 Benches to negotiate these settlements through Lok Adalat.

The preliminary Lok Adalat proceedings were held from 2nd Feb. to 6th Feb., 2009 by various Benches. The negotiating Bench of Lok Adalat got tremendous response from the people for finding legal solutions to their problems. It was an unprecedented event in which both members of the Judiciary as well Executive have shown great interest and enthusiasm to cooperate with each other and arrive at an amicable settlement. At the end of an eventful day, the Lok Adalat was able to resolve about 6,962 cases out of 20,902 complaints it received till 31st January 2009.

The table given below gives a clear picture about the settlement of grievances in the Lok Adalat:



DETAILS OF THE CASES SETTLED IN THE LOK ADALAT HELD ON 07.02.09

S.N.	Name of the Block	Total No. of application received	No. of cases put up	No. of cases of Non-appearance	No. of cases resolved with break up of nature of complaints						Total disposal
					Unemployment allowance	Less payment	No. of Job Card issued	Demand of Job	Matter of Property	Cases for Rejection	
1	Latehar	9849	9849	6109	3	252	48	2854	451	131	3739
2	Manika	2841	2841	2157	*2	46	4	584	36	12	684
3	Chandwa	4719	4719	4370	Nil	39	Nil	195	97	18	349
4	Garu	1110	1110	501	7	88	Nil	482	88	Nil	611
5	Balumath	1456	1456	560	Nil	77	12	755	48	3	895
6	Barwadith	924	924	240	19	79	Nil	476	110	Nil	684
7	Mahuadarn	3	3	3	Nil	Nil	Nil	Nil	Nil	Nil	
Total		20902	20902	13940	31	581	64	5292	830	164	6962

Note: * Combined application of 79 people (Unemployment allowance) was resolved.



One of the major grievances was that even after Job Cards were issued, some workers, due to their ignorance of law under NREGA, did not demand jobs and had claimed unemployment allowances. These cases were treated as applications for demand for job within the meaning of NREGA and amicably settled in the Lok Adalat. In total, 5292 cases of this nature were solved.

Such Lok Adalats on NREGA herald a great leap in the quest of "Justice for all" as promised in the Constitution of our country.

The Hon'ble Executive Chairman observed that Lok Adalat is a continuous process and the complaints which could not be dealt with on 7th February 2009, would be looked into in future and no one should be disappointed. The Award

passed in the Lok Adalat with respect to unemployment allowance was implemented through the distribution of cheques to the rural workers on the spot. The distribution of funds became easy as stalls of various Banks were also installed in the Lok Adalat camp.

The Workshop-cum-Lok Adalat was organized in response to a formal petition submitted by Mr. Jean Derez and Ms. Reetika Khara to Hon'ble Mr. Justice M.Y. Eqbal, Executive Chairman, JHALSA. A lot of effort went behind the organization of the workshop and the Lok Adalat, with full cooperation from the District Court, District Administration and the Department of Rural Development, Government of Jharkhand.

The benefits that emerged are the following:

- A: Sensitization of the concerned persons in NREGA implementing agencies.
- B: Awareness among all the stakeholders about right to employment.
- C: Dissemination of knowledge to the rural workers at grass-root level through distribution of pamphlets, brochures, booklets etc. and installation of NREGA Awareness stall.

Indeed, it was a Herculean task to manage such a huge crowd that day due to the overwhelming response. Rural workers came from the remotest bastis & tolas of the district. The Legal Services Authority worked overtime to handle this mass response and dealt with more than 20,000 applications. The DLSA staff deserve sincere appreciation for their work. JHALSA, under the aegis of NALSA, acted as a responsible leader accepting the challenges by providing legal services to the poor and downtrodden without any hesitation in being the final point through Lok Adalat where the solution is found, decision is taken and action is initiated, knowing fully well that they cannot pass the success, blame or responsibility to a higher authority.